Chicken Caesar Smash Tacos

Main dishes | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Makes: 8 tacos. Equipment: skillet, small pan, and mixing bowl. Prep: chop bacon, shred romaine, and measure the dressing before cooking.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Caesar dressing

Bowl B - Chicken seasonings

Bowl C - Fats for panko

Bowl D - Panko finishing ingredients

Caesar dressing:

- [ ] 3/4 cup whole-egg mayonnaise [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp grated Parmesan [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp lemon juice [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp Dijon mustard [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp minced garlic [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 tsp black pepper [Bowl A]

Tacos:

- [ ] 7 oz bacon, chopped
- [ ] 1 lb ground chicken
- [ ] 1 tsp garlic powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp onion powder [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp sweet paprika [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl B]
- [ ] 8 small flour tortillas
- [ ] Olive oil, as needed

Crispy topping:

- [ ] 1 tsp olive oil [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp butter [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1/2 cup panko breadcrumbs
- [ ] 1/4 tsp salt [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp grated Parmesan [Bowl D]

To serve:

- [ ] 2 cups shredded romaine
- [ ] 1/4 cup grated Parmesan

1. Mix the dressing

1. Whisk together 3/4 cup whole-egg mayonnaise, 2 Tbsp grated Parmesan, 1 Tbsp lemon juice, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, 1/2 tsp minced garlic, 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce, 1/4 tsp salt, and 1/4 tsp black pepper. Set aside.

2. Cook the toppings

1. Cook 7 oz chopped bacon in a skillet until crisp. Drain and set aside.

2. In a small pan, heat 1 tsp olive oil with 1 Tbsp butter. Add 1/2 cup panko and toast 2-3 minutes, until golden. Stir in 1 Tbsp grated Parmesan and 1/4 tsp salt. Set aside.

3. Prepare and cook the tacos

1. Mix 1 lb ground chicken with 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp onion powder, 1 tsp sweet paprika, 1/2 tsp salt, and 1/2 tsp black pepper.

2. Divide into 8 equal portions. Press one portion in a thin layer onto each of 8 small flour tortillas.

3. Lightly oil a skillet and heat over medium-high. Cook tortillas chicken-side down until the chicken is browned and cooked through. Flip briefly to warm and crisp the tortilla side.

4. Assemble

1. Divide 2 cups shredded romaine, the cooked bacon, prepared dressing, 1/4 cup grated Parmesan, and crispy panko among the tacos. Fold and serve immediately.